Clearing the Teams cache

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Summary

This article guides users and service-desk agents through clearing the Microsoft Teams cache to resolve common issues such as the app not loading, audio problems, screen-share failures, or a status stuck on "Away". It outlines preliminary checks, a step-by-step self-help procedure for Windows and macOS, the actions agents should take when assisting remotely, and how to verify that the cache clearance succeeded.

Symptoms

- Teams fails to launch or gets stuck on a blank screen
- Audio drops or echo during meetings
- Screen-share button greyed out or sharing does not start
- Presence status remains "Away" despite activity
- Error messages like "We couldn't connect to Teams" or "Something went wrong" appear

Common causes

- Corrupted local cache files (IndexedDB, GPUCache, blob_storage, etc.)
- Outdated Teams client version causing compatibility issues
- Conflicting permissions (e.g., missing screen-recording consent on macOS)
- Network glitches that leave stale data in the client

Preliminary Checks

Before clearing the cache, verify that the issue is not caused by a broader service outage or a missing permission. Ask the user to check the Microsoft 365 service health page via the Teams client or portal. Confirm that the user can sign in to Teams on another device or the web app; if the problem persists there, the issue may be account-related rather than local cache corruption.

On macOS, ensure that screen-recording permission is granted for Teams (System Settings > Privacy & Security > Screen Recording). Without this permission, screen sharing will fail even after a cache clear.

Verification and Confirmation

After the cache has been cleared and Teams restarted, the user should perform a quick validation:

- Attempt to start a Teams meeting and confirm that audio is clear and the microphone works.
- Try sharing a screen or an application window; ensure the sharing toolbar appears and the content is visible to attendees.
- Check that the presence indicator updates correctly when the user changes status or becomes active.
- If the original problem was Teams not launching, verify that the sign-in screen appears and the client loads the chats and teams list within a reasonable time (usually <10 seconds).

If all checks pass, inform the user that the issue is resolved and close the ticket. Should any symptom remain, collect logs (Teams -> Settings -> About -> Version -> Get logs) and escalate per the escalation guidance below.

1. Confirm user can access Teams on web or another device
2. Guide user to quit Teams and delete cache folders (Windows/macOS)
3. Alternatively run Intune script to delete cache folders
4. Have user relaunch Teams and verify symptom resolution
5. Record steps taken and outcome in the ticket

When to escalate

If clearing the Teams cache does not resolve the issue after verification, escalate to the Messaging & Collaboration

support group. Provide the following details in the escalation ticket: Teams client version (visible in Settings -> About), operating system version, exact error messages or symptom description, steps already taken (including cache clearance), and any relevant log files collected from the user's device. For persistent audio or screen-share problems, also confirm that the required macOS permissions (screen recording, microphone, camera) are granted and that the user's network meets the minimum bandwidth requirements for Teams.

Keywords: Teams cache, clear Teams cache, Teams not loading, Teams audio issue, Teams screen share not working, Teams status stuck away, Reset Teams, Teams troubleshooting, Microsoft Teams, Acme IT help